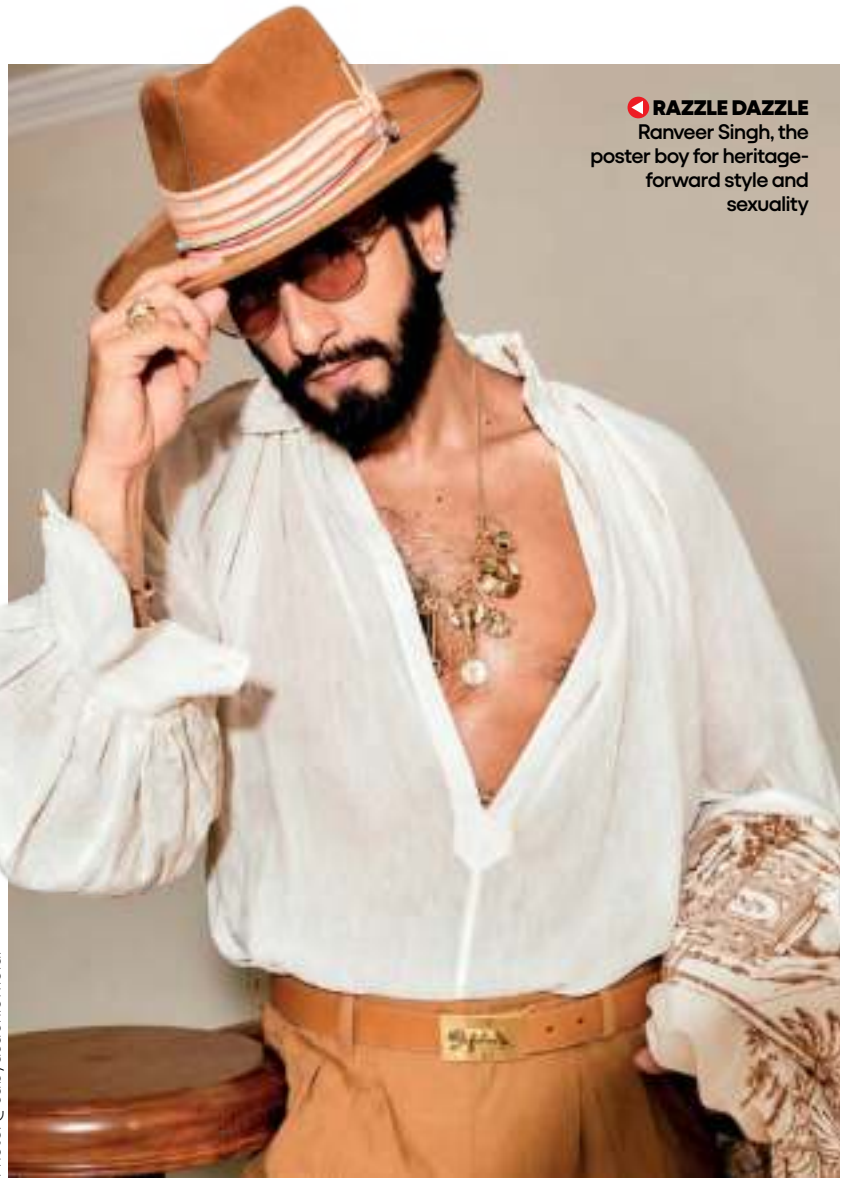


RAZZLE DAZZLE Ranveer Singh, the poster boy for heritage-forward style and sexuality

Photo: @sabyasachiofficial

calm, restrained image. Rap stars are close behind, with Vivian Fernandes, Honey Singh, Raftaar and Badshah wearing chunky chains and oversized rings that channel the raw, unadulterated energy of their music. Diljit Dosanjh brought his Punjabi aesthetic to Coachella in 2023 with layered necklaces and silver cuffs fitted with designer jackets and turbans.

THE GOLD RUSH

As a response, bands are pivoting to expand their range. Nearly a third of the inventory sold by Candere (part of Kalyan Jewellers) is now exclusively for men. "Earlier, the men's category was limited to classic rings, pendants and wedding bands," says Madhavan, of Limelight Lab Grown Diamonds. "Today, we have introduced everyday luxury pieces—titanium rings, kurta buttons, ceramic and tennis bracelets, belt buckles, solitaire necklines—that men can style casually or formally." Suraj Shantakumar, company director of Coimbatore-based Kirtilal Kalidas, has seen a rise of interest even in the traditional south Indian market. "Cufflinks, brooches and pendants are emerging categories. The primary consumers are men aged roughly 25-50, especially professionals, entrepreneurs and business communities," he says. His company has now tripled their range. "The latest trend is brooches for men," says Dhruval Dholakia, head of operations and resources at Shree Ramkrishna Exports. "For years, we had about three designs in our range. Last year, we increased it to 21."

Even though the rising popularity of men's jewellery is too small to offset the losses faced by the larger industry, troubled by geopolitical and export headwinds, the Indian man has arrived just in time to take advantage of evolving cultural norms. For once, women alone will not have to bear the charge of extravagance in everyday appearance. ■

WHAT MEN WANT

Three distinct male jewellery aesthetics are gaining popularity in India, from the subtlest to the flashiest



Minimalist
Signet rings, thin chains, small studs. Driven by office-friendly aesthetics, 'elegant but visible' styles

Streetwear
Chunky chains, iced-out pendants, oversized rings. Popularity driven by rappers, especially among the Gen Z





Maximalist
Baroque pearl necklaces, antique silver chains, flashy hip-hop rings. For ceremonial wear and championed by icons like Ranveer Singh and Diljit Dosanjh